views of Zionism that seemed simple to the point of banality. “For me Zionism is a house, allowing security for all the citizens of the state,” Herzog explained. “Zionism is to maintain that no one can transfer our money under the table,” added Stav Shaffir, a young Labor MK who rose to prominence as a social activist and fought in the Knesset against funneling money to illegal West Bank settlements. “Zionism is responsibility. Responsibility of the state for education, for livelihood, for health care—for all of us,” said Shelly Yachimovich, who served as Labor chairwoman before Herzog.

If the video was meant to challenge anyone, that person was Naftali Bennett, one of the most charismatic politicians in Israel—a source of either inspiration or terror, depending on your political leanings. Bennett is the leader of the Jewish Home, a right-wing party that draws its support largely from the “national-religious” sector (*dati leumi*, in Hebrew). The term conjures up images of bearded settlers, but in reality the community is heterogeneous and hard to define. Pollsters from the Israel Democracy Institute (IDI), a respected middle-of-the-road think tank, tried to do so in a comprehensive 2014 survey, but admitted they weren’t even sure how to choose a sample population.[6] Some 3 per cent of Israelis who identified as national-religious also paradoxically described themselves as secular. Bennett himself is not a settler, but a high-tech entrepreneur who lives in Ra’anana, a stony suburb north of liberal Tel Aviv. He is a Modern Orthodox Jew, but his wife was not religious before they met. His party’s popular second-in-command, Ayelet Shaked, is also secular.

Still, as the name suggests, the national-religious camp trends towards a more religious, nationalistic worldview. Among the respondents to the survey, 78 per cent told IDI they identified as right-wing on foreign policy and security issues. A plurality opposed both civil marriage and allowing same-sex couples to join their synagogues, while a majority believed that rabbis should have authority over the votes of religious Knesset members. Three-quarters of them agreed that students should be segregated by gender. In the 2013 election, center-left parties received 37 per cent of the overall vote, but just 9 per cent from the national-religious electorate.

Most significantly, the survey found that nearly a quarter of Israeli Jews identify as *dati leumi*. Previously the group was thought to comprise no more than 10 per cent of the Jewish population. And the growth of this sector seems to be accelerating. One-third of the Israeli Jewish population is